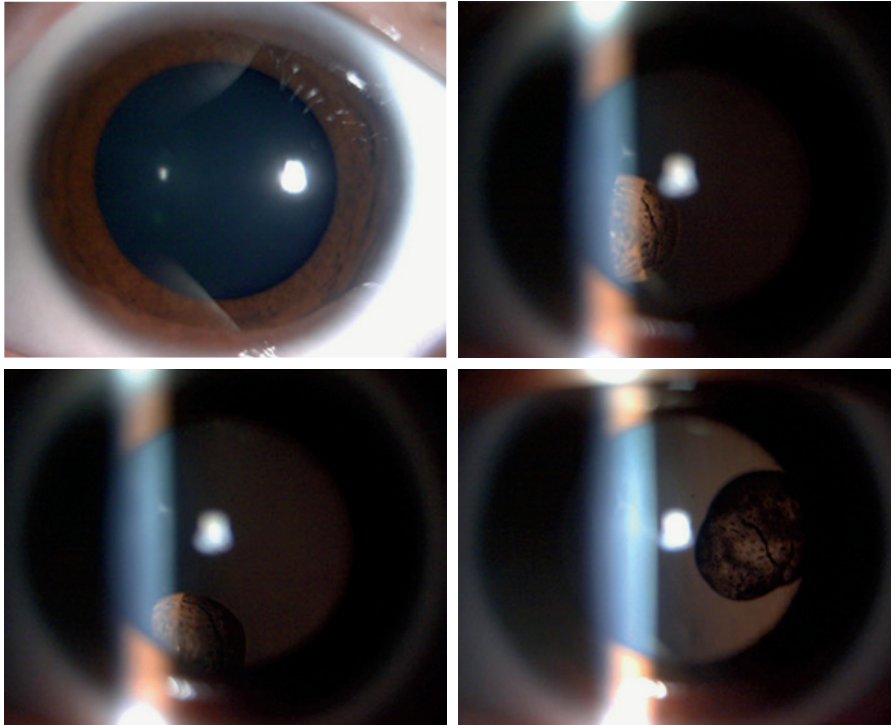


IMAGES IN CLINICAL MEDICINE

Stephanie V. Sherman, M.D., *Editor*

Free-Floating Cyst in the Vitreous



A HEALTHY 18-YEAR-OLD MAN PRESENTED TO THE OPHTHALMOLOGY clinic with a 1-day history of seeing a “floating ball” in his left eye when he blinked. He had no history of infection, trauma, or travel. On examination, both eyes had a visual acuity of 20/20, quiet anterior chambers, normal irises and pupils, and normal intraocular pressures. On slit-lamp examination of the left eye, a spherical, brown-pigmented mass was seen floating freely in the vitreous when the patient blinked (see video). A B-scan ultrasound examination showed a cystic mass with hyperechoic thin walls. Routine laboratory testing and imaging of the brain, chest, and abdomen did not show any abnormalities, and examination of the stool for ova and parasites and tests for antibodies to toxoplasmosis were negative. A diagnosis of iris pigment epithelium cyst was made. Iris pigment epithelium cysts are located on the anterior or posterior surface of the iris and may detach into the vitreous. They are usually asymptomatic but may cause blurry vision, floaters, visual field defects, or secondary glaucoma. Because this patient had no visual deficits, his cyst was monitored. At follow-up 5 months later, the cyst remained stable.

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